Vitality and Persistence of Sanskrit

Sanskrit is a language amazingly rich, efflorescent, full of luxu
riant growth of all kinds, and yet precise and strictly keepin
within the framework of grammar which Panini laid down tw
thousand six hundred years ago. It spread out, added to its

richness, became fuller and more ornate, but always it stuck to
its original roots.

In the years of the decline of Sanskrit literature, it lost some
of its power and simplicity of style and became involved in highly
complex forms and elaborate similes and metaphors. The gram-
matical rule which enable words to be joined together, became
in the hands of the epigones a mere device to show off their
cleverness by combining whole strings of words running into
many lines.

Sir William Jones observed as long ago as 1784: 'The Sanskrit
language, whatever be its antiquity, is of a wonderful structure;
more perfect than the Greek, more copious than the Latin and
more exquisitely refined than either: yet bearing to both of them
a stronger affinity, both in the roots of verbs, and in the forms